Intuitive Dashboard & Skills-Tu Life UX/UI Analysis Findings

PREPARED FOR

Intuitive Thinking Skills

The Think Tank Online Learning Platform

PREPARED BY

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Executive Summary

This report details the findings of a comprehensive User Experience (UX) and User Interface (UI) analysis of The Think Tank Intuitive Dashboard and Skill-Tu Life Course. The evaluation was conducted from the perspective of two key user personas: a vulnerable service user with low technical confidence, and a technically proficient former service user tasked with evaluating the platform.

The analysis uncovered five major usability issues, including a critical failure to save and display user progress, which severely undermines user trust and motivation. Other high-severity issues include confusing site navigation and ambiguous exit procedures, which create anxiety and a frustrating user experience.

These findings directly impact the platform's primary goal of successful course completion. However, all identified issues are solvable. This report provides a series of actionable, prioritised recommendations designed to significantly improve usability, increase user engagement, and ultimately help deliver the proven, positive impact of the in-person courses in a digital format.

Project Goals & Methodology

PROJECT GOALS

The primary objective of this analysis was to evaluate the online platform from different users perspective to identify key areas for improvement. The specific goals were to:

- Map the end-to-end user journeys for core user types.
- Identify points of friction, confusion, and frustration in the user interface.
- Discover any technical bugs or errors impacting the user experience.
- Formulate actionable recommendations to improve the user journey and increase course completion rates.

METHODOLOGY

The findings in this report are based on a structured, qualitative analysis using the following industry-standard UX research methods:

- **Persona-Based Analysis:** Two detailed user personas were created to ground the analysis in the context, goals, and technical abilities of the platform's real users. All tasks were performed while embodying these personas.
- **Cognitive Walkthroughs:** The analyst performed key tasks (e.g., finding a course, completing a module, checking progress) while simulating the mindset and knowledge of a first-time user to identify usability issues.
- **Heuristic Evaluation:** The platform's interface was assessed against Jakob Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics to identify violations of established design principles, such as consistency, user control, and visibility of system status.

Who are we designing for?

User Persona 1:

Mark, 38 (The Service User)

Quote: "I just want to get this done without the tech getting in my way."

Goals: Fulfill program requirements, learn coping skills, feel a sense of accomplishment.

Situation:
Mark is in recovery for substance misuse and has been referred to the "Intuitive Recovery" online course by his support worker. He has limited access to transport, so completing the course from home is his only option.

Technical Skills:
Basic. He uses a smartphone for browsing and social media but is not highly confident with complex websites. He can get easily frustrated by confusing forms or navigation.

Goals & Motivations:
To fulfil the requirements of his recovery program; to genuinely learn new coping strategies to maintain his sobriety; he is motivated by clear, simple steps and a sense of accomplishment.

Fears & Frustrations:
Fears that he won't be "smart enough" to complete the course or that the technology will be too complicated; gets frustrated when he can't find what he's looking for quickly and is likely to give up if he hits a roadblock.

User Persona 2:

Alex, 25 (Service user/Ambassador)

Quote: "The in-person course was life-changing. I hope the online courses can live up to that."

Goals: Evaluate the digital experience, complete staff training, ensure the platform is effective for others.

Situation:
Alex is a former service user who has successfully completed several of the company's courses in person and progressed to the ambassador course. He has been granted access to the online platform to complete formal staff training and to test the new online versions of the service user courses he is already familiar with.

Technical Skills:
Highly proficient. Alex is a junior programmer and is comfortable with a wide variety of software and web platforms. He has a professional understanding of what makes a good user interface and is more likely to notice technical bugs and design inconsistencies.

Goals & Motivations:
To evaluate how well the powerful in-person course experience translates to a digital format; to complete the necessary staff training to formalise his role; he is driven to use his technical skills to identify concrete areas for improvement.

Fears & Frustrations:
Fears that the core message and emotional impact of the courses will be lost online; frustrated by technical flaws that create barriers for less tech-savvy users; annoyed by illogical user flows and redundant clicks.

Finding 1:

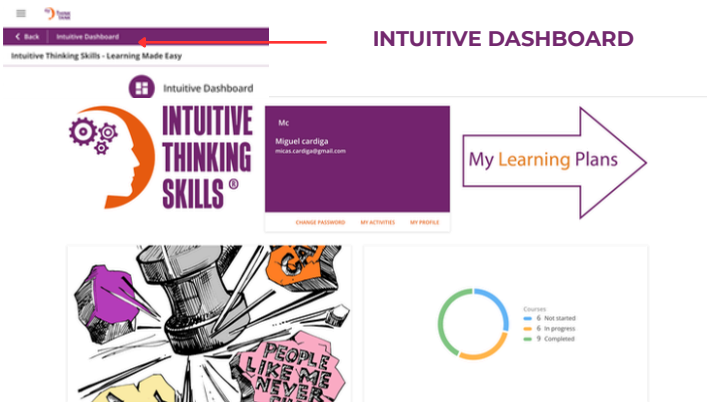
Confusing and Redundant Main Navigation

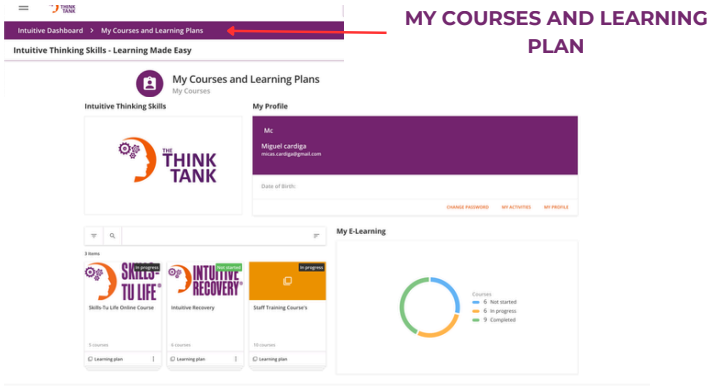
Detailed Description:

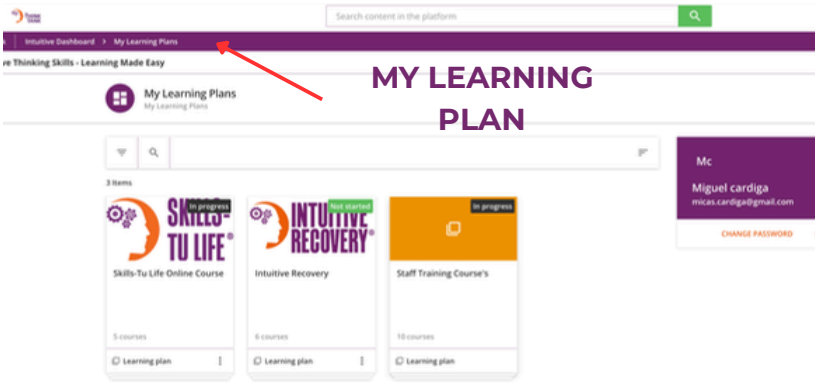
The user's sense of "home" or their main dashboard is unclear. The "Intuitive Dashboard" contains a "Back" button which navigates to the "My Courses and Learning Plans" page, implying "My Courses" is the main hub. However, there are also links within the dashboard to a nearly identical page called "My learning plans." This creates two separate pages with almost the same content and purpose, increasing cognitive load and making navigation confusing for a user trying to find their bearings.

Actionable Recommendation:

Consolidate "My learning plans" and "My Courses" into a single, true "Dashboard" that serves as the user's definitive homepage after login. This page should clearly display all enrolled courses and their progress without needing to navigate to separate, similar-looking pages. The navigation should be simplified to remove any ambiguity about where the user is.







Finding 2:

Passive Learning Experience and Lack of User Agency

Detailed Description: The current design forces the user to wait for a voice-over to finish reading the on-screen text before they can proceed. This removes user control and can lead to frustration and distraction rather than engagement. The peer-led, interactive nature of the in-person courses is lost. Users are talked at, not engaged with. This passive experience is less effective for learning and retention.

Actionable Recommendation: Give users more control and increase interactivity. Some ideas on how to implement this:

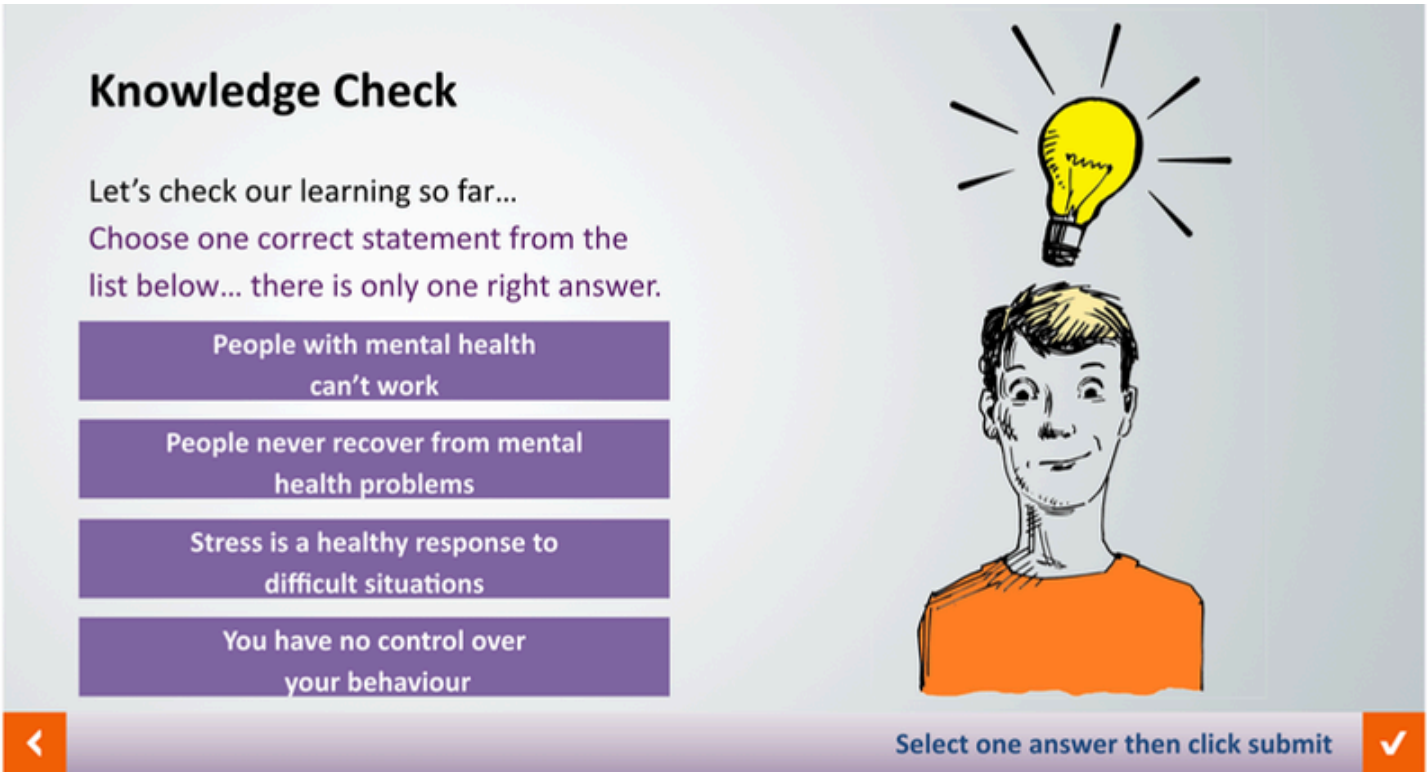
- Voice-over speed/volume controls
- More journal exercises
- Interactive quizzes before and after a topic to show progress
- Short peer-led video/voice message testimonials instead of just voice-overs
- "research to find answer" type questions (like some of the ones found in the think tank **Staff Training Course's**).

Finding 3:

Static and Ineffective Knowledge Check Quizzes

Detailed Description: The "Knowledge Check" quizzes do not appear to contribute to course progression. Furthermore, the questions and the position of the answers are always the same on every attempt. This encourages memorising the answer's position rather than learning the actual content. It represents a missed opportunity to reinforce learning effectively and test comprehension.

Actionable Recommendation: Enhance the quiz functionality. Create a question bank for each chapter and randomise the questions and the order of the answers for each attempt. Tie quiz completion to the chapter's progress to make them feel meaningful and integral to the course.



Finding 4:

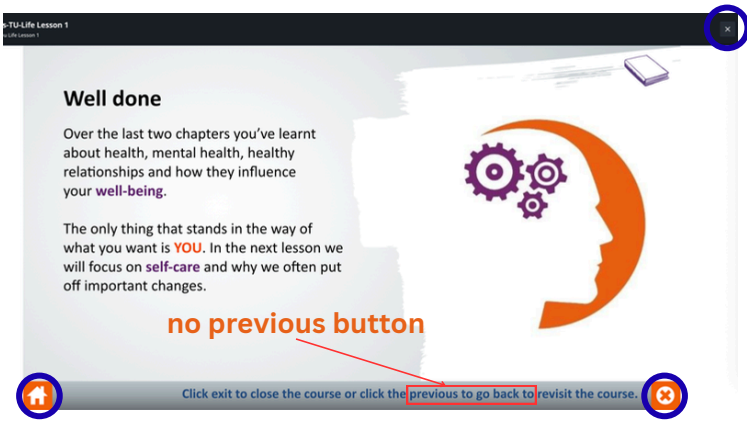
Ambiguous Exit Options and Confusing Terminology

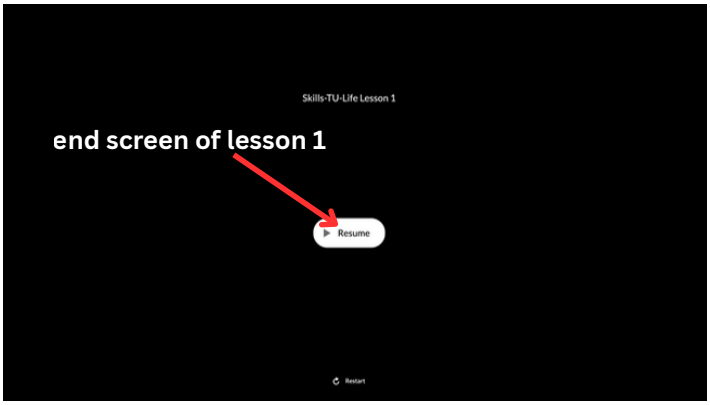
Detailed Description:

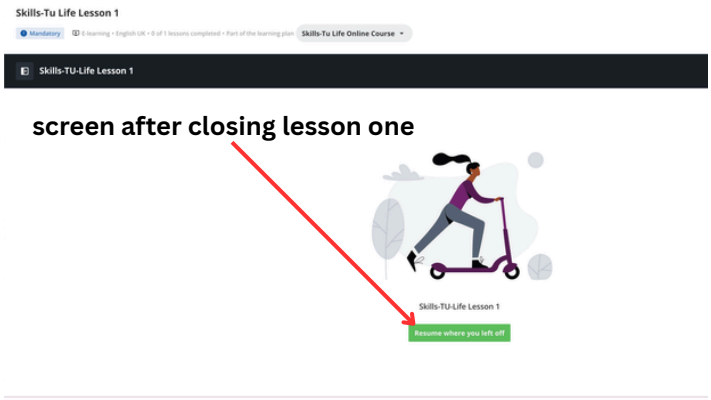
The course player has unclear exit options, with a "home" icon and two "exit" buttons creating confusion. This is made worse by the progress-saving issue, as the user has no idea which button (if any) will save their work. Additionally, the inconsistent use of "course," "lesson," and "chapter" throughout the platform makes it difficult for a user to understand the structure of the content and their place within it.

Actionable Recommendation:

Redesign the course player navigation to be clear and simple. Use a single, clearly labeled "Exit to Dashboard" or "Save and Exit" button. Standardize the content hierarchy terminology across the entire site (e.g., Course > Module > Chapter) and use this language consistently in all descriptions and menus.







Finding 5:

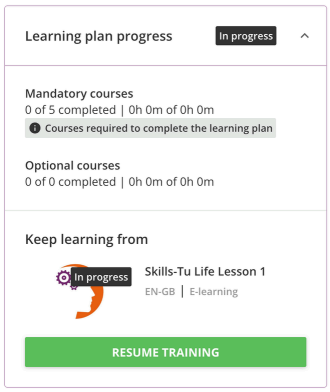
Progress is Not Visibly Saved or Tracked

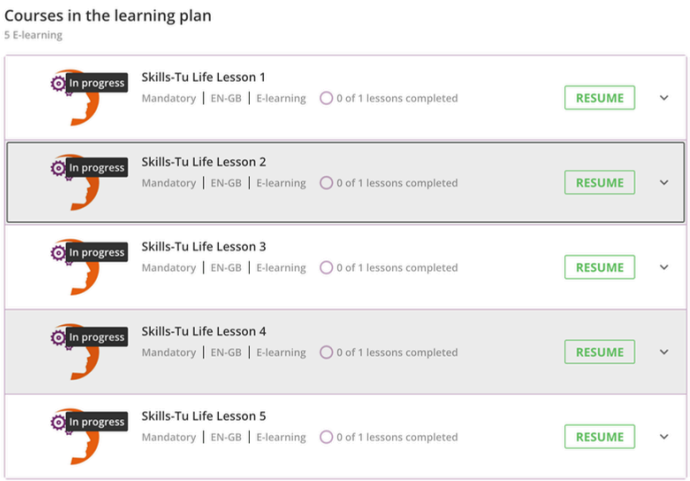
Detailed Description:

This is a critical issue. The system consistently displays "Resume" on chapters that have already been completed. When clicked, it takes the user to a seemingly random slide mid-lesson, not the beginning or end. This signals to the user that their progress is not being saved. For a service user like Mark, who needs to prove course completion, this is a major failure. It breaks trust in the system and removes the motivation to continue, as their hard work appears to be lost. The core advantage of online learning doing it at your own pace is nullified.

Actionable Recommendation:

Implement a stateful progress tracking system. Completed chapters must be clearly marked as "Complete" (e.g. with a green checkmark). The "Resume" button should accurately return the user to the last slide they viewed. Provide a clear progress bar (e.g. "7/10 Chapters Complete") on the main course page to give users confidence that their work is being saved.





Summary of Recommendations

1. Consolidate "My learning plans" and "My Courses" into a single, true "Dashboard" that serves as the user's definitive homepage after login.

2. Implement a stateful progress tracking system. Completed chapters must be clearly marked as "Complete," and a progress bar should be visible on the course page.

3. Give users more control and increase interactivity by implementing features like voice-over controls and more interactive exercises.

4. Enhance the quiz functionality by creating a question bank to randomise questions and answers for each attempt.

5. Redesign the course player navigation to be clear and simple with a single, clearly labeled "Previous, Save and Exit" button.

Minor Usability Issues

1. The company logo image in the page footer appears slightly pixelated on high-resolution screens.

2. Standardise the content hierarchy terminology (e.g., Course, Module, Chapter) across the entire site for clarity.

3. Page load time for the "Intuitive Dashboard" was noticeably slower than other pages during testing.

4. WCAG 2.2 Errors and Alerts:
   a. The course is not accessible using only keyboard
   b. Some Invalid “aria-labelledby”
   c. Couple instances of insufficient normal text contrast on the main Intuitive Dashboard

- More detailed information on WCAG issues on the next page

Intuitive Dashboard WCAG 2.2 issues and errors:

Level 1 - the most essential issues to address
Violation
Text contrast of 2.85 with its background is less than the WCAG AA minimum requirements for text of size 14px and weight of 600
The tabbable element's role 'presentation' is not a widget role
The ARIA role 'link' is not valid for the element <img>
The 'id' "language-selector-title-fb141fc1-abb9-4f9c-8e77-aade8226c0ac" specified for the ARIA property 'aria-labelledby' value is not valid
The 'id' "dialog-title-aria-label" specified for the ARIA property 'aria-labelledby' value is not valid
Needs review
Check the keyboard focus indicator is visible when using CSS declaration for 'border' or 'outline'
The foreground text and its background color are both detected as #ffffff. Verify the text meets the WCAG AA requirements for minimum contrast
The input element does not have an associated visible label

Skills-Tu Life Course WCAG 2.2 issues found:

Level 1 - the most essential issues to address	39
Violation	6
Text contrast of 2.85 with its background is less than the WCAG AA minimum requirements for text of size 12px and weight of 500	4
The 'id' "language-selector-title-fb141fc1-abb9-4f9c-8e77-aade8226c0ac" specified for the ARIA property 'aria-labelledby' value is not valid	1
The 'id' "dialog-title-aria-label" specified for the ARIA property 'aria-labelledby' value is not valid	1
Needs review	33
Check the keyboard focus indicator is visible when using CSS declaration for 'border' or 'outline'	12
The input element does not have an associated visible label	7
The foreground text and its background color are both detected as #ffffff. Verify the text meets the WCAG AA requirements for minimum contrast	4
Confirm the element should be tabbable and if so, it becomes visible when it has keyboard focus	2
Confirm this text 'MC' is used as a heading and if so, modify to use a heading element or role	2
Confirm this text 'Intuitive Thinking Skills - Learning Made Easy' is used as a heading and if so, modify to use a heading element or role	1
Verify the contrast ratio of the text against the lightest and the darkest colors of the background meets the WCAG AA minimum requirements for text of size 18px and weight of 600	1
The 'placeholder' is the only visible label	1
Verify the element with "menu" role has keyboard access	1
Verify the CSS background image does not convey important information	1
Confirm Windows high contrast mode is supported when using CSS to include, position or alter non-decorative content	1